

Tobias Treppmann

Design Engineer — design the decision in running code, against real data

LOCATION Berlin, Germany

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PROFILE

I design in Figma and decide in code. At Bibel TV I prototype against real production APIs and engineering ships from that code. The design system underneath is mine: DTCG tokens in four tiers, with CI checks that refuse off-system work. The problem I keep returning to is human-agent interfaces: giving an agent context and staying upstream of the send.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The design decision gets made in running code. I prototype the product against real APIs, web first then Android, and engineering ships from that code.
- A color engine, and the tool that tunes it. Both live in production. K-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry perceptual weight.
- Human-agent interfaces, shipped. An AI support copilot in production for viewer services, drafting in the handbook's wording. A restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and every send decision stays human.
- Design system as an API: DTCG tokens in four tiers, built with Style Dictionary to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source. Built without a platform team.
- Interaction detail tested in product: responsive behavior across web and Android, with accessibility shipped under the EU Accessibility Act.
- The tickets are mine to write. I spec and prioritize what engineering works from, and check the built feature rather than calling it done at handoff.
- Own UI quality across four platforms. Product managers prototype day to day, and an external engineering agency builds from my working reference.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Extended the platform instead of adding to it. Booking built on the existing calendar and form builder, not as a standalone module, so one build covered room rentals and weddings too.
- Three stakeholder groups with opposing needs on one surface: funeral directors, parish assistants and priests.
- A scheduling mistake in that workflow is not a minor inconvenience.
- Two engineers, two months, daily contact. Design in Figma, build in code, and I was in the build every day rather than at the end of it.
- Accessibility met by the product. An EU accessibility law landed on churches whose sites the platform hosts; we shipped what met it automatically, six countries, under GDPR plus church law.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- On Ninox's Senior Leadership Team, with 5 direct reports including a design lead. I owned the design system there and established joint governance with engineering.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Executive-level mandate in a 100+-person shared-services organization. Partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense B2B interfaces. Big-data pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. Necessary complexity kept, weight kept off.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach. Pioneered iterative [usertesting.com](https://www.usertesting.com) screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers.
- The platform operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks.
- Design system. I defined component behavior and specs across the library.
- Functional head, two direct reports, peer among department heads under a VP of Design. Led the design team across Germany and NYC throughout.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Design Consultant · *Ninox Software GmbH* · Summer 2025 · freelance · prompt-to-database AI onboarding

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalen Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

How I Work in Code

Prototyped in real code against real production APIs, web first then Android · Iteration moved from working code into external implementation · Engineering at Bibel TV is an external agency, so that handoff crosses a company boundary · The honest split: HTML, CSS and some JavaScript by hand, everything else agentic · I direct the model rather than typing the framework, and I would rather say so now than have you find it in week two · Claude Code, Claude Projects and Claude skills as daily tools, plus Zed · Figma and Figma Variables · HTML, CSS, JavaScript · SwiftUI · Storybook · Dovetail and usertesting.com · “Designing with and for AI” workshop series run since 2024 with a partner agency

Color, Contrast and Visual Systems

Built Bibel TV’s color engine and the tool that configures it, both live in production · K-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid instead of some cards demanding the page and others disappearing · Low-vibrance clusters filtered so a muddy beige cannot win by covering the most pixels · Text validated against base with the WCAG algorithm, lightness and chroma adjusted until the pair passes, so no theme ships failing · Every threshold a dial in the config tool, no commit needed

Human-Agent Interfaces

A support copilot live in production, where the person stays upstream of the send · Restricted topics named in an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt and the draft suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry · Prompt-to-database onboarding at Ninox, where the generated schema renders into the real editor rather than a chat preview, so it can be inspected and corrected instead of accepted blind · An AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end, from analysis through prompt architecture and prototype to a production skill

Dense Enterprise Workflows

Fifteen years of complex B2B software · Five years of data-dense B2B interfaces at Datameer — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards, filter logic · The query-builder preview, where the result is a sample and the interface has to say so without becoming unreadable · Three stakeholder groups with opposing needs on one ChurchDesk surface, in a workflow where a scheduling mistake is not a minor inconvenience · Analysts inside top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers, reached through screening built for institutions that had never granted research access

Design Systems as Infrastructure

Design-system ownership at Bibel TV: DTCG tokens in four tiers (primitives, semantic, component, page and view), built with Style Dictionary and platform-agnostic, serving iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source · One commit propagates to every platform that consumes it, which is what makes the high-quality choice the fast one · Governance run as a cross-functional working group with assigned members and an escalation path · Defined component behavior and typography aliases; custom motion easing curves in the Datameer design system · Accessibility shipped under regulation rather than advocated · Responsive and mobile-first across web, iOS, Android and connected TV

Where I Have Led

Team of five including a design lead at Ninox, on the Senior Leadership Team · Product management and all of product design held together at ChurchDesk · Design team across Germany and NYC for five years at Datameer · Listed last on purpose — this application is for the work, not the title